WORKSHOP HANDOUT · SESSION 2 OF 4

Writing prompts that work the first time

Five habits that turn vague requests into reliable results — for any model, image or text.

1. **Name the role and the reader**
   "You are a senior UX writer. Write for first-time users on mobile." Context beats cleverness.

2. **Describe the output, not just the topic**
   Format, length, tone and structure: "3 bullet points, under 60 words, friendly but direct."

3. **Give one good example**
   A single example of the style you want is worth a paragraph of adjectives.

4. **Leave blanks for what changes**
   Turn specifics into {{blanks}} so the prompt is reusable: {{product}}, {{audience}}, {{tone}}.

5. **Ask for a check before the answer**
   "List any assumptions first" catches misunderstandings before they cost you a rewrite.

Before

```
Write a product description for my candle.
```

After

```
You are a copywriter for a slow-living brand. Write a 70-word description of {{product}} for {{audience}}. Mention scent notes and burn time. Calm, sensory tone. No exclamation marks.
```

YOUR CHECKLIST

- [ ] Role & reader defined
- [ ] Output format stated
- [ ] Length limit set
- [ ] Tone in 3 words
- [ ] One example included
- [ ] Blanks for variables
- [ ] Constraints listed
- [ ] Asked for assumptions